

A full-page background image of a sunset over the ocean. The sun is a bright orange orb partially obscured by a layer of clouds on the horizon. The sky is a mix of blue and orange, with scattered clouds catching the low light. The ocean surface is visible at the bottom, reflecting the colors of the sky.

*Whispers
of
Wonders*

June, 2026



Editorial	2
Curiosity Corner	3
Fascinating Creatures	4
Exploring the Cosmos	7
Recent Discovery: Where Wonder Lives	10
Creativity Corner	12
Behind the Bookshelves: In Conversation with a Librarian	13
From Our Bookshelf	16
Young Storytellers	19
Brushstrokes & Beyond	23
Through the Lens	24
The Fun Zone	25
Word Scrambles	26
Spot the Difference	27
Puzzles & Riddles	28
Find the Words	29

Editorial



Dear Readers,

Welcome to another exciting issue of our magazine!

This month, we're setting off on an incredible journey—from the mysterious red landscapes of Mars to the towering storms of Jupiter. Along the way, we'll discover fascinating facts about the amazing creatures that share our planet, meet a librarian who helps bring stories to life, and celebrate the creativity of young writers and artists.

Every page is filled with opportunities to wonder, learn, and imagine. We hope these stories inspire you to ask questions, explore new ideas, and see the world with curious eyes.

Thank you to all our young contributors, readers, parents, teachers, and friends who continue to make this magazine a place where curiosity grows and creativity shines.

Happy reading!

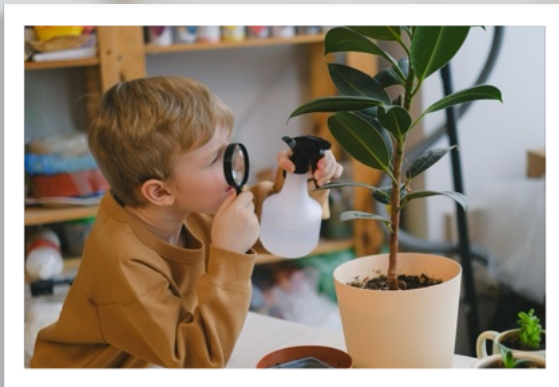
Kamalina Mukherjee

Editor-in-Chief

Aadrita Chattopadhyay

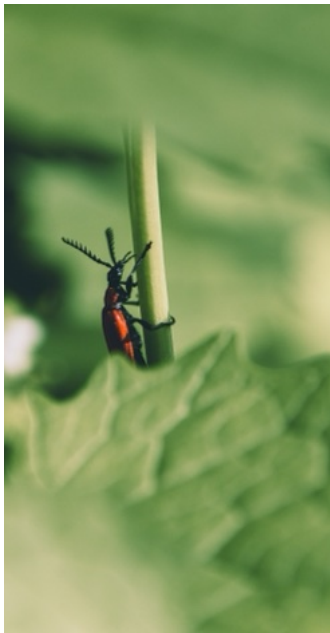
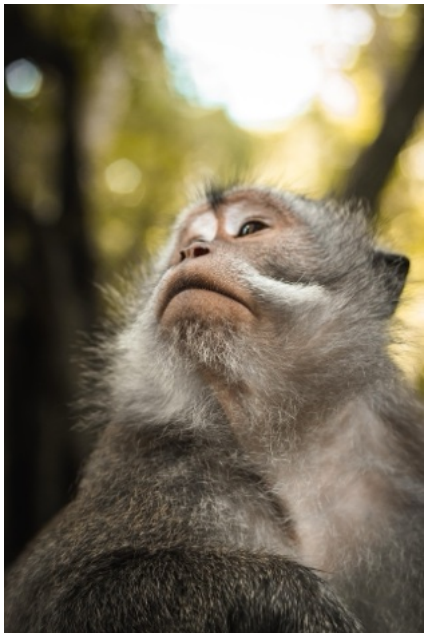
Co-Editor

Curiosity corner



Fascinating Creatures

Our planet is home to an astonishing variety of life, from tiny insects to the giant animals ever to exist. Every creature has its own remarkable story, teaching us about survival, adaptation, and the delicate balance of nature. By learning about animals from different habitats, we gain a deeper appreciation for the incredible biodiversity of our world.



In this issue, we travel from the forests of Australia to the vast oceans. Meet the ever-smiling **Quokka**, often called the happiest animal on Earth, and dive into the underwater world of **Dolphins**, intelligent marine mammals known for their playful nature, remarkable communication, and close-knit family bonds. Get ready to discover what makes these animals truly extraordinary.

The Smiling Quokkas

By Katherine Statz

Do you know what Quokkas are? Quokkas are a type of animal. This is how you say its name KWAH-kah. Some people call them the *happiest animal on earth* because it always looks like they are smiling.

They are the size of a house cat. They have brown fur. Its tail is thin like rats or mice. Like Kangaroos, the mother has a pouch on her tummy where the baby is called a joey and the joey goes in the pouch!

Quokkas only live on one island in Australia called Rottnest island. Quokkas are endangered but Australia is protecting them in nature reserves.

I hope you learned something about Quokkas!



The Delightful Dolphins

By Charlotte Statz

Dolphins are mammals. There are 43 different kinds of dolphins, including the Amazon River dolphin, dusky dolphin, orcas, and the bottlenose dolphin. Dolphins live in the ocean and some even live in rivers and lakes. They live in groups to find food and stay safe. Dolphins talk with clicks, squawks, and whistles. A baby dolphin even knows the sound of its mother's call. Dolphins use these noises and *echolocation* to find their food. They like to eat fish, squid, shrimp, and crabs. Dolphins breathe air through a blowhole on their head. They love to play! I've seen dolphins at the beach and wish I could swim with them someday.



Fun Fact:

Dolphins can jump as high as **20 feet** above the water.



Exploring the Cosmos

For thousands of years, people have gazed at the night sky with wonder, asking questions about the planets, stars, and the mysteries beyond our world. Today, powerful telescopes and space missions allow us to explore these distant worlds like never before, revealing breathtaking landscapes and astonishing discoveries.

This issue takes you on a journey to two of our Solar System's most fascinating planets. Explore **Mars**, the mysterious Red Planet that may once have had rivers, lakes, and conditions suitable for life and **Jupiter**, the mighty giant with its swirling storms and countless moons.

We are especially excited to share these space explorations through the eyes of two young contributors, Debashis and Manavdip, who share a deep fascination for the universe beyond our planet. Their curiosity about planets, space missions, and the mysteries of the cosmos has inspired them to research and share their discoveries with our readers.

Join us as we uncover the wonders that continue to inspire scientists and space explorers around the world.



Mysteries of the Red Horizon

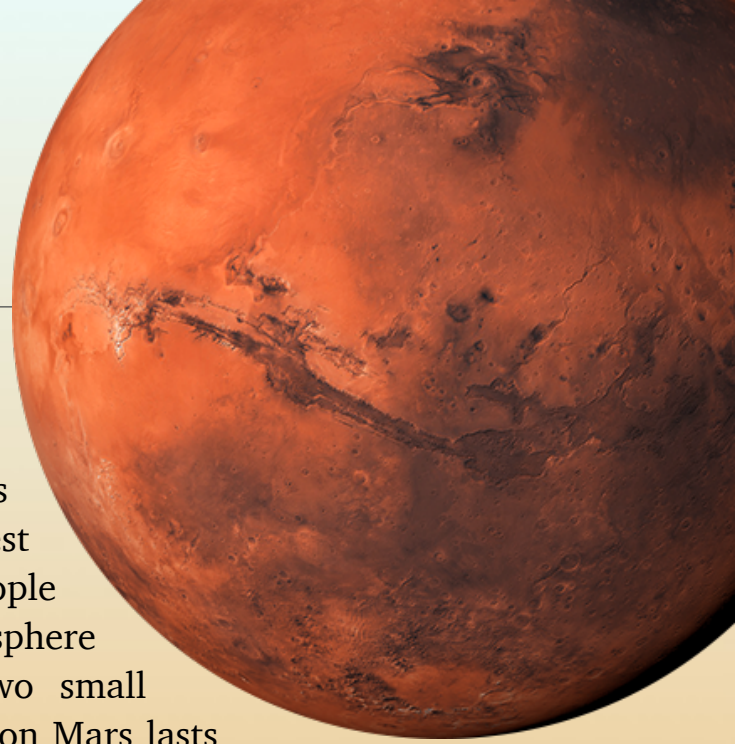
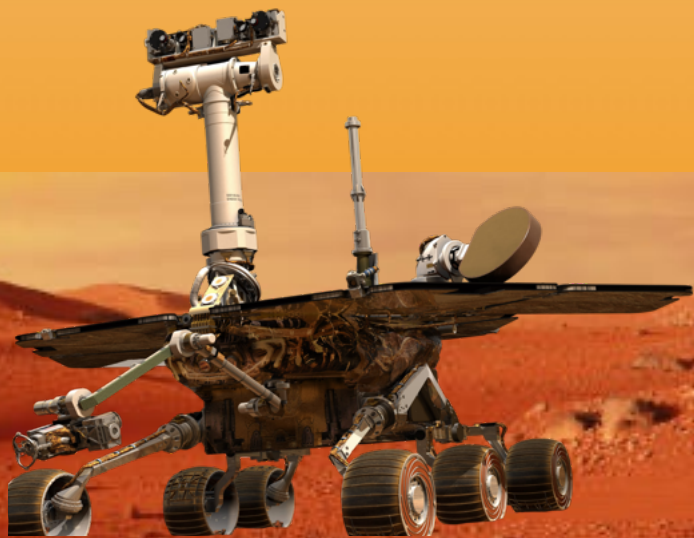
By Manavdip Saha

Mars is the fourth planet from the Sun and is often called the Red Planet because of its rusty-red color. It is one of Earth's closest planetary neighbors and has fascinated people for thousands of years. It has a thin atmosphere made mostly of carbon dioxide and two small moons named Phobos and Deimos. A day on Mars lasts about 24 hours and 37 minutes, making it very similar to a day on Earth.

Mars is home to Olympus Mons, the largest volcano in the entire Solar System. Scientists have found strong evidence that rivers and lakes of liquid water once flowed across its surface. Today, most of its water is frozen as ice at the poles and deep beneath the ground. Like Earth, Mars has four seasons because its axis is tilted. Over the years, many spacecraft have visited the Red Planet to study its rocks, weather, and climate, and to search for signs that life may once have existed there. NASA's Curiosity and Perseverance rovers continue to explore its surface, making exciting new discoveries. Scientists hope that one day humans will also set foot on Mars.

Did You Know?

In 2014, India's (ISRO) **Mangalyaan** became the first spacecraft from India to reach Mars. India also became the first country ever to enter Mars' orbit successfully on its very first attempt—a remarkable achievement in space exploration! 🚀🔴





The Mighty Planet Jupiter

By Debashis Chakraborty

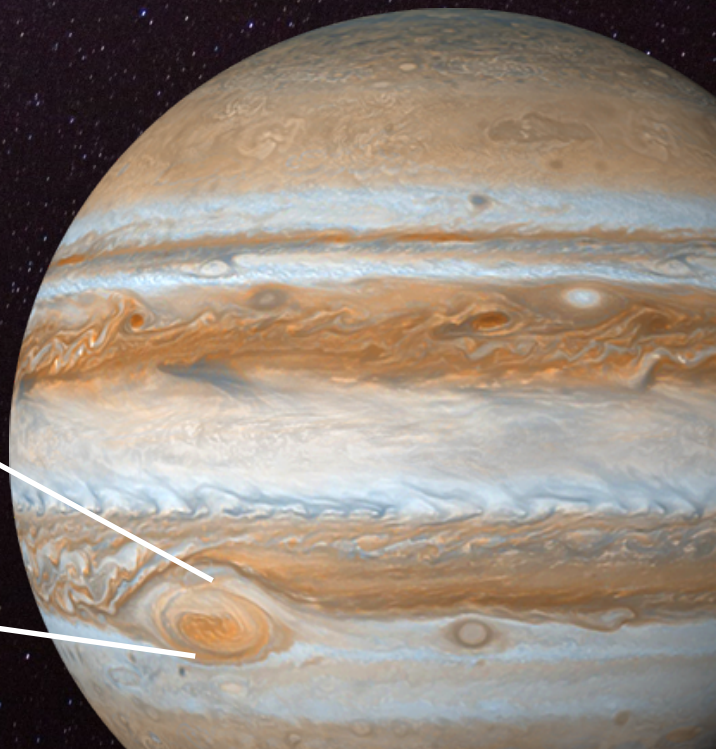
Jupiter is the largest planet in our Solar System. It is a giant world made mostly of hydrogen and helium, earning it the name "gas giant." Jupiter spins faster than any other planet, completing one rotation in just under ten hours.

It is the fifth planet from the Sun and takes nearly twelve Earth years to complete one orbit around it. Jupiter has ninety-five known moons. The four largest—Io, Europa, Ganymede, and Callisto—are known as the Galilean moons. Ganymede is the largest moon in the entire Solar System, even bigger than the planet Mercury.

Jupiter is famous for its colorful bands of clouds and swirling storms. The most well-known of these is the Great Red Spot, a gigantic storm that has been raging for centuries. This enormous storm is so large that several earths could fit inside it.

In Hindu tradition and Indian scriptures,, Jupiter is associated with '*Brihaspati*', the wise teacher and guru of the Devas (gods).

A close-up of the Great Red Spot captured by NASA's Juno spacecraft in April 2018



Recent Discovery: Where Wonder Lives

By Aadrita Chattopadhyay

I always felt a strong connection to the deep blue world. When I was little, my parents frequently took me to SeaWorld in Florida where I saw playful dolphins, vulnerable manatees, sea turtles, mighty orcas, octopuses. We walked through glass tunnels and saw fierce sharks swimming above our heads. We also visited the Shedd Aquarium in Chicago and saw fascinating sea creatures - like the Beluga whales, stingrays, sea stars and sea otters.

In my imagination, I had already searched for lost pirate ships beneath the waves and swam with mermaids.

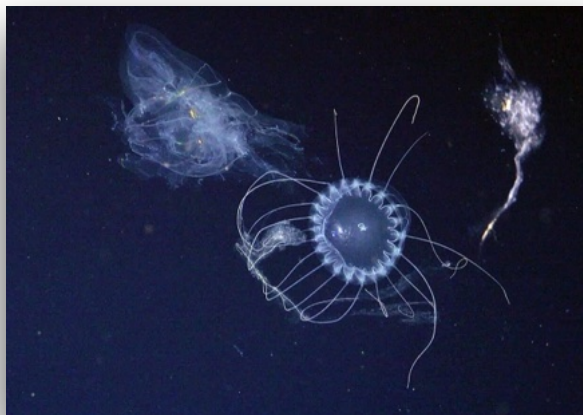
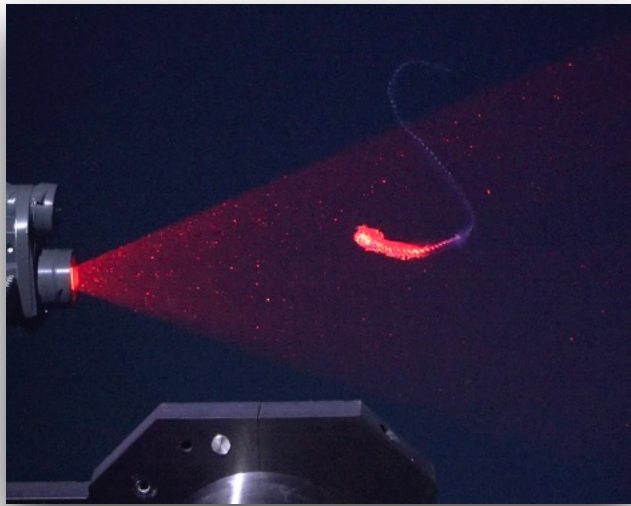
Somewhere along the way, I began to think I knew the ocean pretty well.

But today my mom said something that made me think how much do I really know about the ocean.

Mom told me that Dr Karen Osborn and her team has discovered 31 new species in the mid-water area of the ocean from a research ship, called Falkor. Until now, scientists were mostly interested in creatures closer to the surface and have not learnt much about the mid-water region underneath. From this layer, if you travel downward towards the seafloor it becomes incredibly dark, and if you move upward towards the surface it becomes much brighter. So, Dr Osborn and her team of marine biologists decided it is the time to explore this silent and mysterious world.



So, they sailed on the ship and set up a mobile laboratory aboard. They used special tools, powerful cameras, smart imaging systems, fancy computers, underwater robots with lights shining through their eyes. They began to slowly immerse the robots and the cameras under water. They waited for a while but then, one by one, strange animals were seen through the cameras. Some of these creatures were as clear as glass, others were glowing softly like tiny underwater stars. Within two weeks, this group of marine scientists discovered 31 new species that no human has seen before.



What an incredible feeling that must have been! I realized that the ocean isn't just big—it is unimaginably vast.

When we talk about exploring new worlds, we often think about the distant planets in farthest end of our galaxy. But I find it fascinating how little we even know about our own planets - our neighbors from the deep blue world.

When I was younger, I dreamt of finding a pirate's treasure beneath the sea. Now I know the greatest treasures aren't made of gold at all—they're the incredible creatures still waiting to be discovered.

Creativity Corner



Creativity Corner

Behind the Bookshelves: In Conversation with a Librarian

Have you ever wondered what it's like to work in a library surrounded by thousands of books? We sat down with our beloved librarian Erika Walston from the Gaithersburg Public Library to learn more about her job, her favorite parts of being a librarian, and why libraries are such special places. Join us as we explore the world behind the bookshelves!

1. Library Collection

Q. How does the library collect so many books?

A: We buy our books. Sometimes people donate them and we add them to the collection. But we have a big budget to buy all of these lovely books and other things too, like movies, video games and things like that.

Q. If someone asks you for a particular book, how do you find it in the library?

A: We look it up in something called a catalog. Inside, I type the title into the computer and it gives me its location and the call number, and then I go look for it on the shelf since it is in a specific order.

Q. When people return the books, how do you know where to put them and how do you organize the books?

A: Great question! We know where to put the books because each book is assigned to something called a call number and it is on the spines. So, after we check it in, we put it on a cart and someone sorts it for us. Sometimes it is alphabetically, like our fiction books, so it is from A-Z. And if it is a non-fiction book, it is assigned a number and we put it all the way from 0-999.



2. Journey & Inspiration

Q. What inspired you to be a librarian?

A: Good question! I really like books and I really like history. So, I first wanted to do something called a Special Collection Librarian where you deal with really special books, like old books or rare books. But then I realized that I also like children and I also like working with children, so I took a job as a children's librarian. So, I get to do a lot of fun programs.

Q. What is your favorite part of being a librarian?

A: It's a good question. I actually really really love doing children's programs, so I like doing story times, our science and arts programs, because I like doing fun projects and sharing information with people.

3. Personal Connection to Books

Q. What was your favorite book when you were a kid?

A: I have so many favorite books. I loved a picture book called Each Peach Pear Plum which I really liked. And for chapter books, I liked Ella Enchanted and it's still one of my favorites.

Q. Can you suggest a few books for children to help develop and maintain critical thinking?

A: I would say, any book, really. If you read them and talk about. Sometimes mysteries are a good place to start, because you have to get the context.

Q. Like the Encyclopedia Browns?

A: Yeah, those are good, like Cam Jansen, like they have to solve a little mystery. The Encyclopedia Browns are good because there are clues in the text.

Q. How do you do fact-checking ?

A: There is a picture book, called Facts vs Opinions vs Robots. I feel like every adult should read it too because it is very clear on what's a fact, and what's an opinion.



From left to right: Aadrita, Marie, and Chloe with librarian Erika Walston, sharing smiles after a delightful conversation about books, libraries, and the joy of reading.

4. Reflection

Q. What do you think books can do that movies and videos cannot?

A: That's a philosophical question. I think that books can let your imagination draw the picture for you, specially if it is not a graphic novel. May be, even if it is a graphic novel. And I think that it lets your mind kind of relax in some way. Yeah, thats a deep question and I don't really have an answer for (laughs)!

From Our Bookshelf

Every great reader begins with a single book. Stories have the remarkable ability to make us laugh, spark our imagination, introduce us to unforgettable characters, and help us see the world through new eyes. Sharing books with one another is one of the best ways to discover stories we might never have picked up on our own.

In this issue, we are delighted to feature two thoughtful book reviews written by our young contributors, Charlotte Statz and Katherine Statz. Though they are young readers, their enthusiasm for books is truly infectious, and their love of reading shines through every page they write.

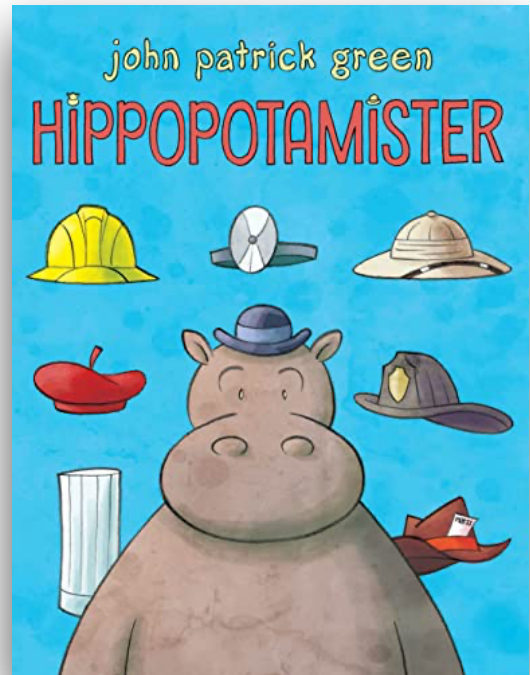
Charlotte introduces us to the delightful graphic novel *Hippopotamister* by John Patrick Green, while Katherine takes us into the magical world of Roald Dahl's timeless classic *Charlie and the Chocolate Factory*. We are incredibly grateful to both of them for sharing these wonderful recommendations & inspiring fellow readers to discover the joy of reading.



Hippopotamister By John Patrick Green

A Book Review by Charlotte Statz

Hippopotamister is about a hippopotamus and a red fox. They live in a very old zoo. They want to see more of the world. They decide to leave the zoo and try to find jobs. They try cooking, hair styling, construction, and more.



I like the book because the red fox does a lot of funny stuff. If you want to read a funny book, this graphic novel would be a great choice!

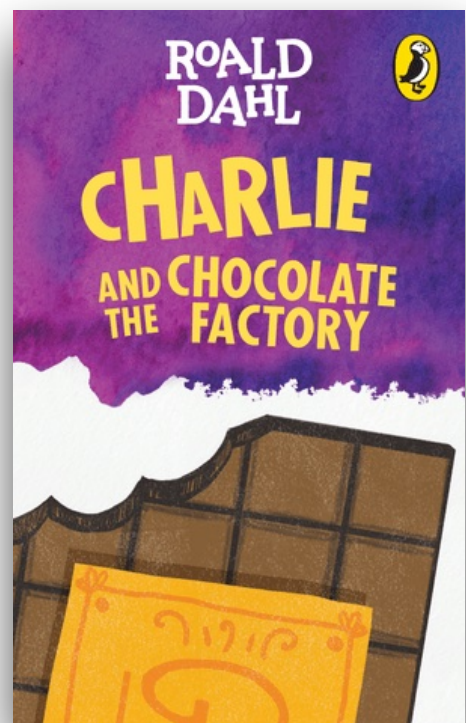


A Book Review by Katherine Statz

Have you ever read Charlie and the Chocolate Factory by Roald Dahl? It is a very good book. It is a novel about a kid named Charlie, whose family is very poor. Mr. Willy Wonka owns a chocolate factory and has sent out golden tickets around the world. Each person who finds a golden ticket gets to go on a tour of the chocolate factory and take home a lifetime supply of delicious chocolate! Five children find these tickets: Augustus Gloop, Veruca Salt, Violet Beauregarde, Mike Teavee, and lastly, Charlie Bucket. You get to read about Charlie's amazing adventures in Mr. Wonka's mysterious chocolate factory!

My favorite part in the book is when the Oompa-Loompas sing. Oompa-Loopas are Mr. Willy Wonka's helpers from Loompa Land.

If you ever see Charlie and the Chocolate Factory at a library, bookstore, or at your house you should read it!



Young Storytellers

Long before we learn to write, we learn to imagine. Stories allow children to turn ordinary moments into extraordinary adventures, giving shape to their ideas, emotions, and dreams. Every tale they create is a reflection of how they see the world—and how they hope it could be.

This issue proudly features two original stories written by our young contributors. Their creativity, thoughtfulness, and enthusiasm for storytelling are truly inspiring. We are honored to share their work and hope it encourages every reader to believe that their own stories are worth telling.



Sarah Stopped Giving Up

By Sharanya Das



Sarah was a kind-hearted well-behaved girl but there was one thing that everybody used to hate when she gave up. When her friends told her to try or to do something, she always said yes, but at the end, she gave up. That's why, after a few days, her friends stopped telling her to do something and Sarah was upset.

Sarah's mother came to her room and said, "Why are you so upset Sarah?" Sarah said, "I always give up and now my friends also stopped telling me to do something". Her mother said, "I am happy that you understood your mistakes but you have to try new things".

After the talk, her mother left the room. Sarah thought about it for a few minutes and said, "I will try my best not to give up". She tried her best, listened to her friends' advice and she did what she could. But she gave up. She also tried few things she hated to do but at the end she gave up.

Sarah's mother told her that why don't you try skating. Its very interesting. Sarah said, "I know but at the end I'll give up like other times". Sarah's mother said that you can take all day if needed but you have to try new things. She did what her mother said and after all her hard work, she learned skating and she stopped giving up.



Moral of the story is: Don't give up.

The Heart Behind the Silence

By Aadrita Chattopadhyay

Every morning on her way to school, Lily saw an old homeless man sitting at the street corner across from her school. His clothes were worn. He looked angry and tired.

Lily always stops to say hi to this man. She greeted him cheerfully with “I hope you have a great morning!” but the man never replied. He didn’t smile, he didn’t wave her back or even look at her. His eyes always seemed far away, as if he was somewhere else.

One day, Lily’s mom noticed this. That night she explained to Lily that the lonely man sitting in front of her school is actually a war veteran. He has bravely fought for our country so we all can be safe. However, during the war, he saw a lot of death, injuries, and blood. He experienced extreme sadness, pain, and heart break. That’s why he looks so distant these days.

Lily could not sleep that night. She thought she could help the man try to be happy again.



The next morning, she went to school. She gathered her friends and wanted to make an announcement: “Everyone, I would like you to make a card for a



man we all have seen on the street right across our school. He is a war veteran. And today we will appreciate him for all his hard work.” Then everybody gets to work.

By the end of the day, all the kids in the class have finished making the cards. They came out of the school and walked to the lonely man across the street. One by one they laid down colorful cards with “thank you” notes and words of gratitude in front of the old man. His eyes filled up with tears. He smiled softly and said, “I thought that everyone has forgotten me. So, I was sad.” Lily sat down beside him and said, “actually, nobody

forgot you. We all remember and treasure you.”

From that day on, the street corner was not a place where a lonely man sat. It was a place where a war hero was remembered.

Brushstrokes & Beyond



With every splash of color, Aadrita brings a magical underwater world to life, where imagination swims as freely as the mermaid herself.

Through the Lens



Nature doesn't always need bright colors to shine. Through Aadrita's lens, this delicate white Hydrangea reminds us that beauty often blooms in simplicity.

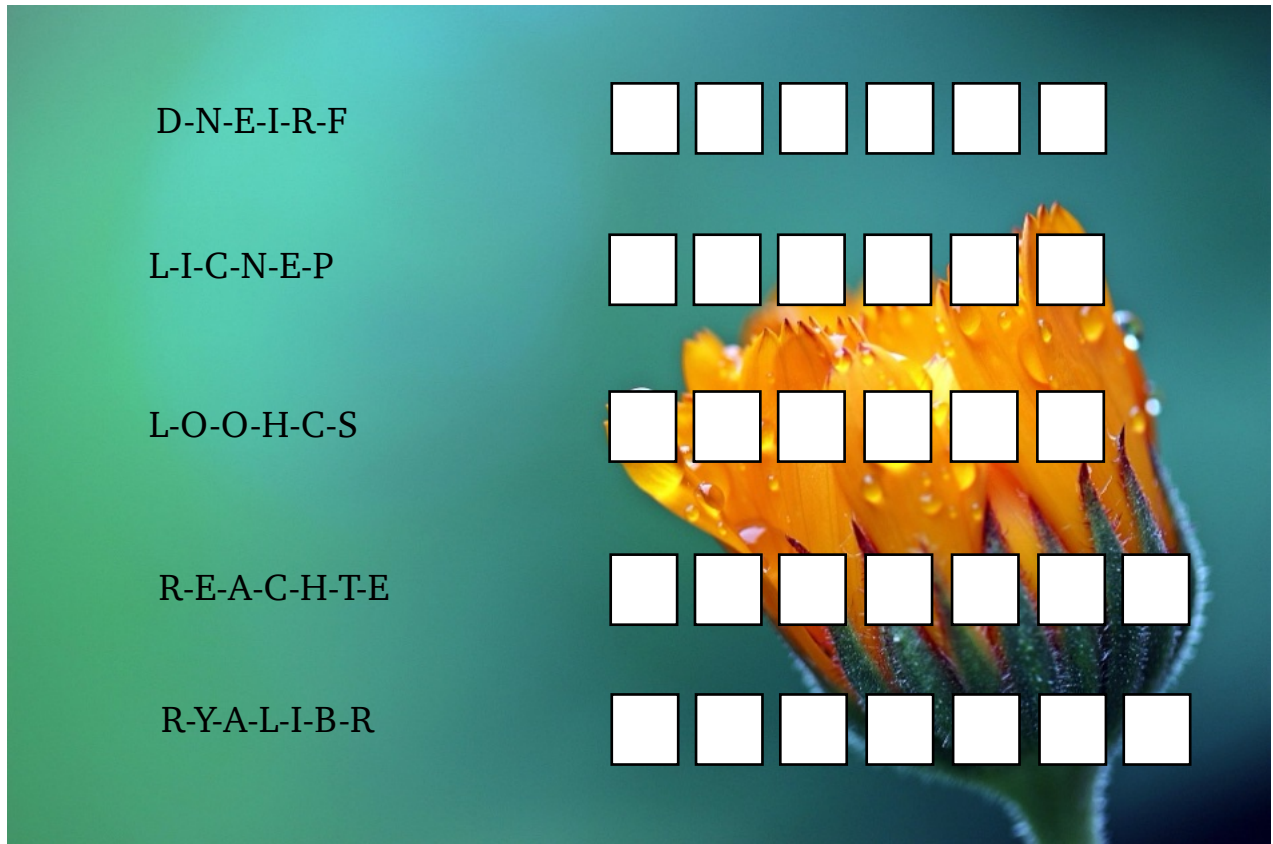


The Fun Zone

Think, Play, Solve

Word Scrambles

A big thank you to our brilliant young friend Chloe for sharing this fun word scramble challenge with us! Her creativity and love for word games have brought us 5 exciting puzzles to solve. Can you find all the hidden words?



Think you have solved them all? Great! Send us your answers to kabitri@gmail.com! We will feature the names of all our clever readers who get the answers right in our next issue. Happy puzzling!

Answers to Last Issue's Word Scrambles:

COMPUTER, BRACELET, ELEPHANT, LANTERNS, ABUNDANT, MERMAIDS

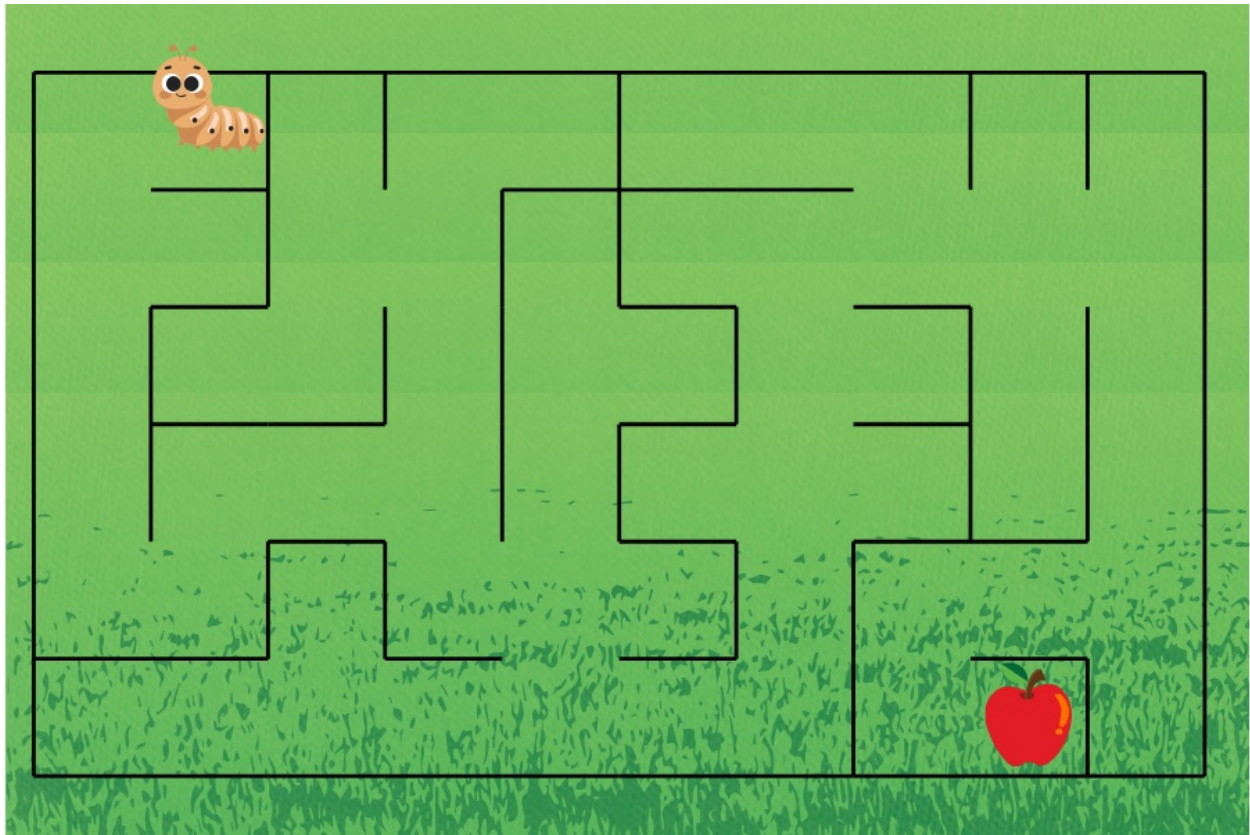
Spot the Difference

Put on your detective hat! These two poolside pictures may seem identical, but they have **6** sneaky differences. Can you find them all?



Puzzles & Riddles

Our hungry little worm is searching for a treat. Help the hungry worm wiggle through the grassy maze and find the juicy red apple waiting at the finish.



1. Why did the cow cross the street?
2. What goes through cities and towns but never moves?
3. What 5-letter word becomes shorter when you add two letters to it?
4. What can you hold in your left hand but not in your right hand?
5. I have keys but no locks. I have space but no room. You can enter but you can't leave. What am I?

- Your right elbow
- A Keyboard

- A road
- Short

- To go to the
Moovie

Find the Words

D	U	Z	P	M	X	F	T	S	O	Q	W	D	H	G
V	P	O	O	L	D	I	A	M	C	W	E	A	F	S
H	G	T	S	E	B	S	U	N	C	Z	A	U	A	U
Y	A	S	K	M	Y	P	L	A	M	W	S	G	E	N
K	S	P	E	O	I	R	A	K	F	A	Q	U	P	S
O	W	L	R	N	P	J	U	N	E	T	O	S	R	C
P	I	A	T	A	X	I	P	S	F	E	M	T	L	R
Y	M	S	Q	D	K	Q	W	D	O	R	V	A	E	E
X	S	H	B	E	A	C	H	I	Y	M	O	V	K	E
F	U	V	K	M	Y	O	R	U	S	E	T	L	I	N
N	I	S	F	I	R	E	F	L	Y	L	S	O	M	C
J	T	J	N	J	V	G	H	A	M	O	C	E	A	N
S	A	O	J	U	L	Y	U	S	A	N	D	M	V	I
W	X	K	L	R	W	T	H	I	L	J	U	B	O	C
P	I	C	N	I	C	K	O	B	U	A	O	P	S	N

A word adventure awaits! Our young contributors Marie and Aadrita have jointly created this fun challenge in the theme of Summer, just for you. Find the hidden words scattered in the grid above - they may appear across or down. Good luck!

Lemonade	Watermelon	Swimsuit	Picnic	August
Pool	Sunscreen	Firefly	Sand	Ocean
Beach	Splash	July	Sun	June

